

Here's a more **human, plain-spoken** version of that text, keeping it professional but easier to read:

What you need to do

To make PDF generation work on the live server, PHP must be allowed to run external programs like **wkhtmltopdf**.

1. Enable `proc_open` on the server

Snappy uses `proc_open` (and related functions) to call `wkhtmltopdf`.

If you manage the server, open the active `php.ini` file and remove `proc_open` from the `disable_functions` list.

Also make sure these functions are enabled as well:

- `proc_close`
- `proc_terminate`
- `proc_get_status`
- `proc_nice`

2. If you're on shared hosting

You usually can't change this yourself. In that case:

- Ask the hosting provider to enable/whitelist `proc_open` , **or**
- Upgrade to a plan that allows it

Without `proc_open` , `wkhtmltopdf` (and any binary-based PDF tool) simply cannot run.

3. Confirm `wkhtmltopdf` is installed

Snappy typically expects `wkhtmltopdf` at `/usr/local/bin/wkhtmltopdf` (check `snappy.php`).

After enabling `proc_open` , verify it on the server by running:

- `which wkhtmltopdf`
- `wkhtmltopdf -V`

If it's not installed, install it via the package manager, or upload a static binary and update the `SNAPPY_PDF_BINARY` value in your `.env` file.

4. Restart PHP / clear config cache

After changing `php.ini` , restart PHP-FPM or Apache (depending on your setup). Otherwise, the changes won't take effect.

Important note

No code changes are needed. This is purely a **hosting/server configuration issue**.

Once `proc_open` is enabled and `wkhtmltopdf` is available, the same code that works locally will work on the live serv